

Develop a Simple Download Scheduler



Here's how to write a few simple scripts and then schedule them to run at a specified time using the *at* utility.

Many of us have an Internet connection that offers unlimited downloads at odd hours, usually around midnight—mine is between 2 a.m. and 6 a.m. What most of us do is wake up late at night to download whatever heavy files we wish to, in order to capitalise on this unlimited bandwidth. However, it becomes quite inconvenient to get up every day in the wee hours and set up things in order to download. Then there's the additional headache of again getting up when the time slot for unlimited bandwidth ends and cancel the downloads. If only there was a way to do these things automatically without the need to manually start and stop the download processes.

In this article, we'll talk about how we can write a shell script to create a simple download scheduler for domestic purposes. Additionally, we'll explore a way in which we could make the PC automatically connect to the Internet, provided we schedule the

job at the required time (scheduling will be described later).

Note that by writing a script, we'd in no way write any functions and programs, but combine some features of the following utilities:

- **lynx-cur** – a command-line Web browser
- **wget** – the non-interactive network downloader
- **Bash shell** – for running our script, of course
- **at** – a utility used for scheduling jobs

Make sure your PC has all the above utilities before going further. **wget**, **at** and **Bash shell**, might be there already. However, the same might not be the case with **lynx-cur**. If it is not present, run the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install lynx-cur
```

How to go about it

The following tasks will be performed by our